

**EAGLES
OUSTED**
Lakewood
slows game
down and
sends North
Olmsted
home in
Division I
district play.
C5



NBA

Lakers, Hornets pull off
multi-player trade. **C3**

BASEBALL

Yankees' Joe Torre
faces cancer fight. **C4**

COLLEGE BASKETBALL

Xavier edges Toledo
in NIT opener. **C4**

Sports

The Chronicle / THURSDAY, MARCH 11, 1999 **C1**

ALL DISTRICT



Area stars shine

COLUMBUS — The area scored big in the annual Associated Press All-District teams announced today.

Two local coaches and two players received the highest honors in the All-District team, covering all schools in the metropolitan Cleveland area next to Lake Erie.

Olmsted Falls pulled off a double, with boys coach Pat Donahue and girls coach Joanne Fossen being named Division II boys and girls Coaches of the Year. Donahue has his Bulldogs in the district championship game Saturday at Admiral King, while

See **ALL-DISTRICT, C2**



OSU's dream: A win

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

INDIANAPOLIS — Jim O'Brien's goal is modest. "If we're playing Saturday, I'll be happy," said the Ohio State basketball coach on the eve of the Buckeyes' first NCAA game in seven years.

No Fantasy Island guy here. No dreams of the Final Four or even a second-round matchup against UCLA.

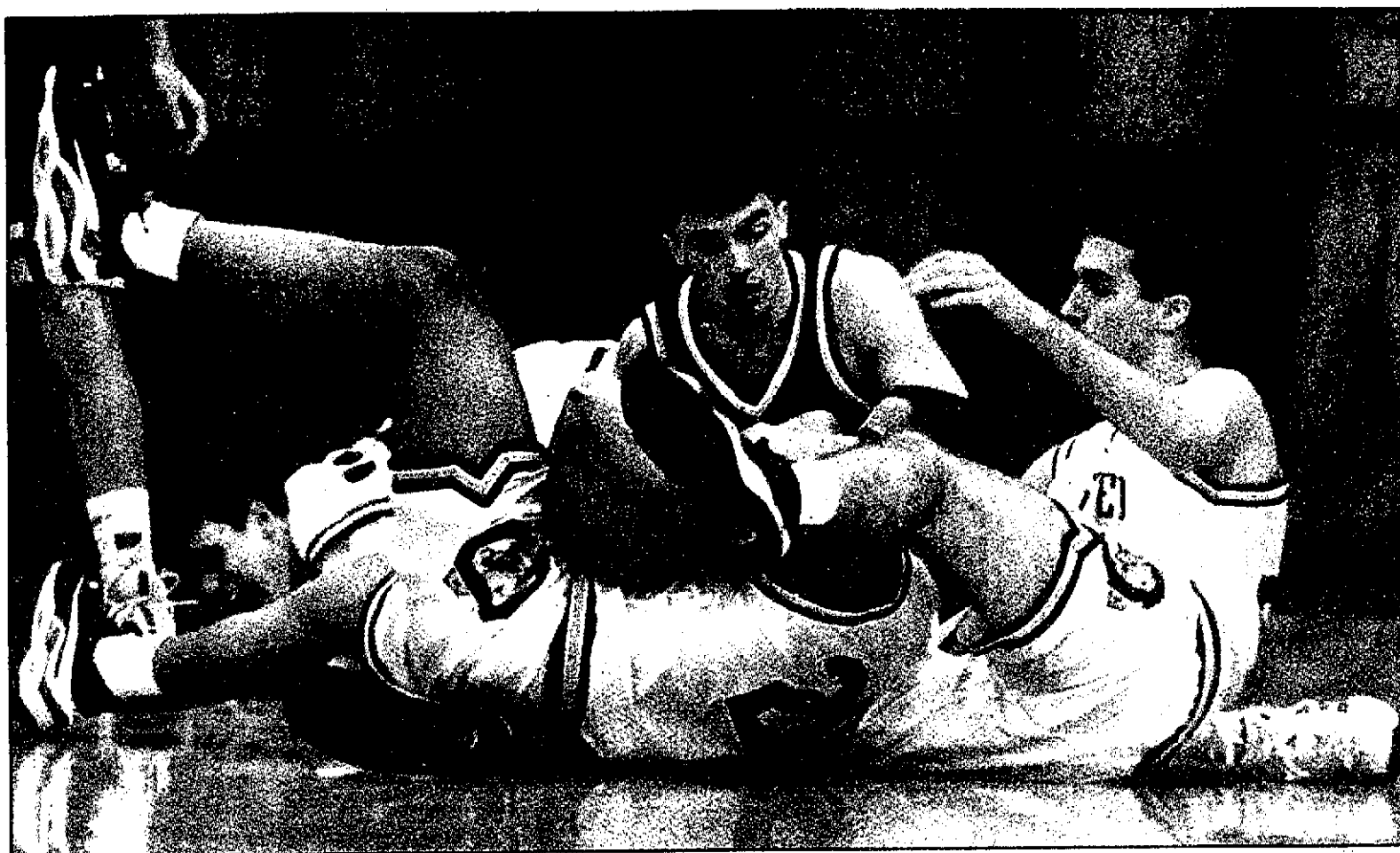
O'Brien won't let anything break his team's concentration for tonight's South Regional game against Murray State at the RCA Dome. The ball will go up at 7:40 p.m.

Ohio State (23-8) comes in as the No. 4 seed. Murray State (27-5), champion of the Ohio Valley Conference, is seeded 13th.

But the Racers have tournament experience on the Buckeyes. They've been in the NCAA

See **OSU, C2**

THE ROAD TO STATE: HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL



JANINE EXNER / CHRONICLE

GET A LEG UP: Avon Lake's Joe Kostelnik, center, struggles for the ball with Falls' Manzie Williams (20) and Brian Williams, right.

The third's a charm

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — Avon Lake got its wish Wednesday night, a third shot at Olmsted Falls in the Division II district semifinals.

Sometimes it's best that wishes don't come true.

The Shoremen played a marvelous first half and were within four points of the Southwestern Conference champions

Falls blows away Avon Lake with another big third quarter

at the break.

But the Bulldogs are a strong third-quarter team and they had already beaten the Shoremen twice during the SWC schedule.

No surprise, then, that Falls turned it around with a mon-

ster third quarter.

With a 19-2 run over four minutes, the Bulldogs went up by 20 points before the period ended and coasted to a 75-52 victory.

They outscored Avon Lake 25-11 in the quarter. The Bull-

dog starters accounted for all 19 points during the four-minute blitz.

Olmsted Falls advances to the district championship game at 7 p.m. Saturday against the winner of tonight's Rocky River-Padua semifinal. Falls (22-2) has beaten Padua by 20 points and split two close calls with River.

See **FALLS, C5**

Clearview falls hard at regional

Jerry Henson
The Chronicle-Telegram

BUCYRUS — It wasn't nerves, Clearview coach Jim Horvath said.

And, he said, it wasn't intimidation.

What exactly was it? Well, a lot of Delphos Jefferson for one thing. And not enough Clearview for another.

The result was a rout as Delphos Jefferson humbled the Clippers 62-33 Wednesday in a girls Division III regional semifinal at Bucyrus High School.

Delphos (16-9) advances to the regional championship game Saturday at 1:30 p.m. against Bluffton, a 61-52 winner over Castalia Margaretta in Wednesday's second semifinal.

Clearview ends the season at 21-4.

"We didn't succumb to tournament jitters or any other pressure," Horvath said. "We weren't awestruck by anyone."

"Simply put, it was a lack of execution. We had all the open looks that we wanted. I have no idea why the ball didn't go in the basket."

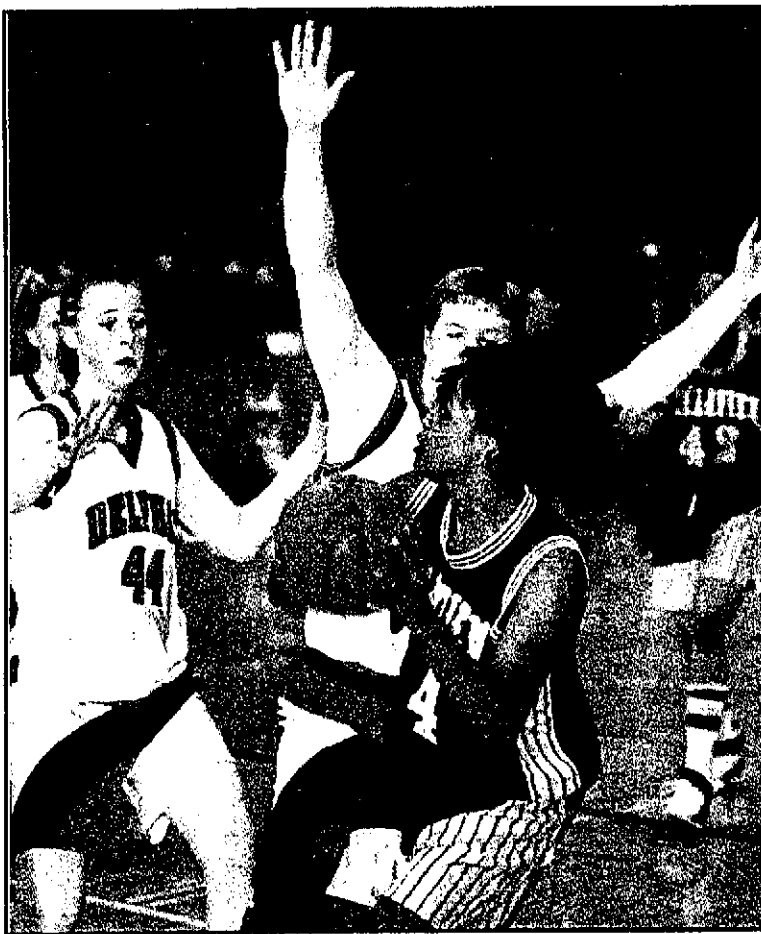
The Wildcats scored the game's first 10 points — including three baskets by Lori Ricker to start things off — and never looked back.

Clearview's LaVonne Davis scored her team's first points with a basket at 2:56 of the first quarter.

With Delphos up 26-11 midway through the second quarter, the Clippers made the last three baskets of the first half to trail 26-17 at halftime.

But the second half was much like the first as the Wildcats quickly returned their lead to double figures. The lead reached 16 on one of Kasie Wreede's three 3-pointers at 3:34 of the third quarter.

See **CLEARVIEW, C5**



STEVE MANHEIM / CHRONICLE

CLOSE QUARTERS: Clearview's Layla Willis finds little room to move against Jefferson's Lori Ricker (44) and Sara Ebbeskotte.

Cavs stun Suns

Chris Tomasson
Knight Ridder Newspapers

PHOENIX — The Cavaliers weren't necessarily happy to see the Suns, just the sun.

"We got up (Wednesday) morning and the sun was out, and that put a smile on our face," said Cavs guard Brevin Knight. "And it was warm out. In Cleveland, the sun can be out and it's 18 degrees."

With smiles on their faces, the Cavs put frowns on the Suns with an 86-73 win Wednesday night at America West Arena.

The Cavs (8-9) hadn't done much smiling lately. They entered the game having lost six of eight and were just 1-5 on the road.

But against the Suns, forward Shawn Kemp wasn't in the dark.

A day after playing his worst game of the season, Kemp came back strong Wednesday night. He scored 18 points on 8-of-12 shooting and had 11 rebounds.

"Shawn Kemp was a monster inside," said Phoenix coach Danny Ainge.

The difference for Kemp on Wednesday night was a strong start: He scored 14 points in the

See **CAVS, C2**

NEXT UP

WHO: Cavs vs. Rockets
WHEN: Saturday, 8:30 p.m.
WHERE: The Summit, Houston
TV/RADIO: Fox Sports Ohio, WEOL 930-AM; WTAM 1100-AM

Money not Orel's primary concern

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — After signing lucrative contracts that bring them millions upon millions of dollars, professional athletes love to say how it wasn't about the money.

Orel Hershisser really means it.

Despite a number of guaranteed offers that not only would've fattened his wallet but opened a position in the starting rotation as well, the 40-year-old free agent chose to sign on with the Indians — a team that already has five starters in Charles Nagy, Bartolo Colon, Jarret Wright, Dave Burba and Dwight Gooden.

Also a team that was offering much less money and absolutely no guarantees.

See **OREL, C2**

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